Shelford in the US, in their key book *Bioecology* (1939), although its origins date back earlier.

The biome concept took shape as ideas on plant succession and community ecology developed. Clements identified “formations,” large plant communities, which led to his idea of climax communities in 1916. The same year, Clements used the term “biome” to describe biotic communities—all the interacting organisms within a specific habitat.